P235/1

Islamic Religious Education

Paper 1

July – August 2026

3 Hours

UGANDA MUSLIM TEACHERS' ASSOCIATION

UMTA JOINT MOCK EXAMINATIONS – 2026

UGANDA ADVANCED CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION

Islamic Religious Education

Paper 1

3 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

- *This examination paper consists of* **two** *sections;* **A** *and* **B**. *It has* **four** *examination items.*
- *Section* **A** *has* **two** *compulsory items.*
- *Section* **B** *has* **two** *optional items. Respond to* **one** *item.*
- *Respond to* **three** *items in all.*
- *Any additional item* **responded** *to will not be scored.*
- *Begin each part of the item on a fresh page.*
- *All responses must be written in the answer sheet(s) provided.*

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SECTION A

Respond to **both** *items from this section.*

Item 1.

The Qur'an teaches that every human being possesses a soul (*nafs*) created by Allah, which undergoes different stages throughout life depending on one's faith and deeds. In **Surah Al-Fajr 89:27–30,** Allah says;

"O tranquil soul! Return to your Lord, well pleased and pleasing to Him. Enter among My servants. Enter My Paradise."

Also, The Qur'an was revealed by Allah to Prophet Muhammad (Peace Be Upon Him) as the final divine revelation for the guidance of humanity. In **Surah Al-Furqaan 25:1,** Allah says;

"Blessed is He who sent down the Criterion (the Qur'an) upon His servant that he may be a warner to all the worlds." **(Qur'an 25:1)**

The above texts highlight teachings on the human soul and the divine revelation that should be used by Muslims in regard to their spiritual life.

Task:

(a) Examine the Islamic teachings derived from the above texts in regard to a Muslim's spirituality.

(b) Analyse the significance of following the teachings provided in the above texts by Muslims in Society today.

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Item 2.

At Shadda Senior Secondary School in Mpita town, the Muslim Students' Association (MSA), together with the local mosque committee, organized a community outreach programme aimed at helping Muslim youth understand the importance of Islamic law (Sharia) in addressing contemporary challenges.

During the discussions, several issues emerged. Ishaan, an Advanced Level student, argued that Muslims today should only rely on the Prophet's effort (Peace Be Upon Him) to develop Islamic law because its development ended with his death since those who had seen him feared claiming that he had not instructed them to do so and hence did not bother to develop it further. She further claimed that Muslim scholars have no authority to solve new issues that did not exist during the Prophet's lifetime. However, some of her classmates didn't agree with her and hence became divided over it.

As preparations for the outreach continued, the organizing committee requested every Muslim student to participate in the congregational Dhuhr prayer before the programme officially began but one of the students; Hanzal refused, claiming that performing the prayer was only a personal choice and that neglecting such an act carried no legal or spiritual consequence because "Allah understands everyone's situation."

During the lunch break, Sarah criticized her classmates for choosing either rice or matooke from the buffet claiming that eating one type of lawful food instead of another could make someone sinful. This caused confusion among several students about what Islam actually considers obligatory and what is simply permissible.

Towards the end of the programme, the participants discussed a widely reported case of Sufur, a young Muslim who publicly announced on social media that he had

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abandoned Islam. Some students immediately demanded that he should personally be punished by members of the community because, according to them, his crime automatically attracts punishment. However, others insisted that no punishment exists for such a crime under Islamic law.

The disagreement over those issues created confusion among the participants. As a result, the outreach programme failed to produce clear guidance for the community, leaving many young Muslims uncertain about how Islamic law should be understood and applied responsibly in contemporary Uganda.

Task:

(a) Examine ways in which Islam offers guidance on each of the issues raised by the young Muslims in the above scenario.

(b) Analyse the challenges to the application of Islamic law in regard to each of the aspects raised by the people in the above Scenario.

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SECTION B

Respond to **one** *item from this section.*

Item 3.

At Kyampisa Muslim Village, the area Imam and the Mosque Committee members organized a family life seminar to strengthen Muslim families. Among those present were Hajji Izudiin, his wife Minata, their daughter Zaitun, their son Asnam, the local Kadhi, and other relatives.

During the seminar, Hajji Izudiin and Minata revealed that they had experienced serious misunderstandings in their marriage for several months. Without seeking any intervention from anyone, Hajji Izudiin announced before the gathering that he had decided to divorce his wife immediately because he didn't want anything to delay their separation. Minata's relatives became angry and also encouraged her to leave the home at once without observing any Islamic procedures. As discussions continued, Asnam argued that Islam gives men greater human value than women and therefore women should not participate in anything such as community leadership. However, Zaitun, who had recently attended a Muslim Women Affairs' workshop, challenged his argument but lacked sufficient Islamic evidence to convince the audience.

Before the seminar ended, Hajji Izudiin suddenly passed away after a pressure attack. But before his death, he had verbally instructed that almost all his property should be given only to Asnam because he was the only son, while his daughters should receive nothing. Soon after the seminar, Asnam immediately began selling part of the family land before the estate had been officially distributed and refused to settle his father's unpaid debts, arguing that he was free to pay it or not since

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everything had automatically become his. Other heirs disagreed but did not know the Islamic guidelines governing Asnam's actions.

The disagreement escalated until both families stopped communicating, children became divided, relatives threatened with court action, and the community lost confidence in peaceful methods of resolving family disputes. The Imam observed that unless these misunderstandings were corrected using authentic Islamic guidance, more families in the community would continue experiencing conflict, injustice, and the breakdown of family unity.

Task:

(a) Examine the Islamic guidelines that should be provided to the people in the above scenario and others with similar challenges to help their families remain united.

(b) Analyse the causes of such behaviour by the people in the above scenario and others like them in society today.

Item 4.

As wedding arrangements drew closer in Kasito Town Council, Mu'tasim and Ummul khair met with a few close relatives to finalize issues concerning their forthcoming marriage. During the discussion, Mu'tasim confidently explained that once a marriage begins, the husband should make all decisions without consulting his wife because too much consideration for her opinions would weaken his authority. He believed that disagreements could best be resolved by ensuring that one person remained firmly in control of the family.

As the meeting progressed, one of the relatives proposed a marriage arrangement involving another member of the extended family, arguing that since everyone was related and trusted one another, there would be no harm in the proposal. Although a

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few people expressed concern, most remained silent because they were unsure whether Islamic teachings placed any limits on such marriages.

The conversation later shifted to the marriage payment. Mu'tasim insisted that all discussions should be conducted only with the bride's guardian since the intended bride had no direct role in the matter. He also maintained that whatever was paid would automatically become family property because they had raised her from childhood.

Towards the end of the meeting, Mu'tasim shared his future plan of marrying several wives once his businesses expanded. When one relative asked how he intended to manage the responsibilities that would arise, he replied that financial success alone would make everything work out naturally and that no further considerations were necessary.

Although the meeting ended peacefully, Ummul Khair and her relatives left with many unanswered questions. They wondered whether the ideas discussed would strengthen family life or gradually create misunderstandings, strain relationships and instability within both families.

Task:

(a) Examine Islamic teachings that should be used to handle the situation in the above scenario.

(b) Assess the likely consequences if each of the issues reflected in the above scenario is not appropriately addressed.

END

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